IEPF: meaning and purpose

Prepared reference notes - checked 6 October 2026

These are assistant-prepared paraphrases of official source passages surfaced in web retrieval. They are not an official MCA/IEPF circular or a downloaded copy of the instruction kit. Full MCA/IEPF downloads returned HTTP 403 during preparation. No claim is made that the 2024 filing kit is the latest version.

IEPF means Investor Education and Protection Fund. Under section 125(1) of the Companies Act, 2013, it is a fund established by the Central Government. The Fund and the IEPF Authority are distinct: section 125(5) provides for an authority to administer the Fund.

Unpaid dividends transferred under section 124(5) form part of the Fund. These notes explain the fund; they do not describe the full list of assets or the complete refund procedure.

Official source references

Companies Act, 2013, sections 124(5), 125(1), 125(5); MCA

https://www.mca.gov.in/Ministry/pdf/CompaniesAct2013.pdf

SRN: Service Request Number in MCA / IEPF filings

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SRN means Service Request Number. The official IEPF-1A instruction kit expands the acronym in its payment-reference field; that kit is a corporate filing guide, not the investor claim form.

For an investor filing Form IEPF-5, the IEPF-5 instruction kit states that submission of the webform generates an SRN. The applicant can retain that reference for future correspondence with MCA. An acknowledgement and indemnity bond are then generated.

This definition concerns MCA / IEPF filings. It is not a definition of an Aadhaar service number, folio number, PAN or ISIN.

Official source references

IEPF-1A official instruction kit, field 3(a), July 2024

https://www.iepf.gov.in/content/dam/iepf/pdf/iepf-forms/Instruction-Kit-Form-No-IEPF-1A-20240718.pdf

IEPF-5 official instruction kit, initial submission steps 9-11, July 2024

https://www.iepf.gov.in/content/dam/iepf/pdf/iepf-forms/Instruction-Kit-Form-No-IEPF-5-20240718.pdf

Transfer of unclaimed / unpaid dividend and shares to IEPF

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Under section 124(5), money remaining unpaid or unclaimed for seven years from its transfer to the company's Unpaid Dividend Account must be transferred by the company to IEPF, with accrued interest, if any. The seven-year period starts at transfer to that account, not simply at the dividend declaration date.

Under section 124(6), shares are transferred where dividend has not been paid or claimed for seven consecutive years or more. If dividend was paid or claimed for any year in that period, the shares are not transferred on that basis.

Before transfer to IEPF, a person entitled to money in the Unpaid Dividend Account may apply to the company for payment under section 124(4). The shareholder does not personally transfer the unpaid dividend to IEPF; the company performs the transfer.

The IEPF-5 instruction kit identifies Form IEPF-5 as the application for claiming unpaid amounts and shares out of IEPF. Do not confuse company transfer filings with the investor refund claim.

Official source references

Companies Act, 2013, section 124(4)-(6); MCA

https://www.mca.gov.in/Ministry/pdf/CompaniesAct2013.pdf

IEPF-5 official instruction kit, title and application process, July 2024

https://www.iepf.gov.in/content/dam/iepf/pdf/iepf-forms/Instruction-Kit-Form-No-IEPF-5-20240718.pdf

IEPF-5 online filing: limited reference from the 2024 instruction kit

Prepared reference notes - checked 6 October 2026

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The 2024 instruction kit describes logging into MCA, selecting MCA services, Company e-Filing, IEPF Services and the IEPF-5 webform for claiming unpaid amounts and shares. Complete the form and submit it. Submission generates an SRN; retain it for correspondence. An acknowledgement and indemnity bond are generated.

This page is a limited filing reference, not a complete current checklist. Use the required attachments displayed in the current official form and applicable instructions. The separately uploaded 2022 sample is historical and must not override newer applicable guidance.

Official source references

IEPF-5 official instruction kit, initial submission steps 1-11, July 2024

https://www.iepf.gov.in/content/dam/iepf/pdf/iepf-forms/Instruction-Kit-Form-No-IEPF-5-20240718.pdf